into standards mode, and you'll very rarely encounter one of these days, much less need to maintain one yourself. (If you're ever asked to, the correct response is "tell me why HTML5 doesn't meet your use case").

HTML Document Metadata

Anyway, back to our modern standards. The head element does not contain any data intended for display (apart from the `title` element). The valid elements allowed as children of head are:

Table 11-7. *HTML <head> content elements*

`<title>`	Contains only text, controls the page title, cannot be omitted or empty
`<base>`	Sets a base URL for all relative URLs in the document, optional
`<link>`	Link to external resource, commonly used to link CSS files
`<style>`	Contains CSS for the page, external stylesheets are preferred
`<meta>`	Metadata that cannot be represented by other elements
`<script>`	Contains executable code/data, or refers to external resource
`<noscript>`	Inserts HTML if scripting is unsupported
`<template>`	Holds HTML fragments for use by a script

As back-end engineers we're most concerned with `<meta>` because there's a whole lot of fundamental stuff you can communicate to the client with these tags. Specifically, you can achieve the following:

- Provide document-wide metadata with `<meta name="..." content="..." />`
- Simulate HTTP headers with `<meta http-eqiv="..." content="..." />`
- Set character encoding with `<meta charset="..." />`
- Set arbitrary metadata with `<meta itemprop="..." />`